

NEW M.2 LATCHES

With the introduction of new slots and ports, there has always existed a trend to switch over to a screwless design over time. All motherboard vendors have been trying out different screwless M.2 mounting mechanisms and the twist-lock mechanism has been the most popular until now. Unfortunately, it's also prone to breakage due to human errors. ASUS has something called Q-Designs for their slots. And this motherboard in particular has multiple easy-release implementations. The first is the Q-Release which is meant for removing M.2 heatsinks. So the mounting mechanism has to handle more load of the metal heatsink without making it too complicated to attach or detach. For the slots without heatsinks, there are springy Q-Latch locks which is basically a curved plastic bit that holds the M.2 SSD in place and is easily opened by a simple flick of your finger. And the last mechanism is the M.2 Q-Slide which allows you to mount 42 mm, 60 mm, 80 mm or 110 mm M.2 SSDs without having to move the locking mechanism to different screw holes.

WI-FI 7 AND 5 GBE NETWORK CONNECTIVITY

The ASUS ROG STRIX X870E-E GAMING WIFI comes with Wi-Fi 7 and Bluetooth 5.4. While getting Wi-Fi 7 routers in India isn't easy thanks to the 6 GHz band still not being available for public use, there isn't a similar restriction on Wi-Fi 7 clients. The Government has been mulling over the issue and the latest update was that it might release the 6 GHz spectrum so that Wi-Fi 7 devices can operate with ease. The onboard Wi-Fi 7 is accompanied by one of ASUS' Q-Antenna which includes some of the beamforming tech-

nologies that improve signal reception on Wi-Fi 5/6/7.

Then there's the 5 GbE ethernet port which is a welcome addition on mainstream motherboards especially when mainstream routers are now shipping with 2.5 GbE ports at affordable price points. This will primarily aid folks looking to run transfers on home networks since internet plans with more than 1 Gbps bandwidth are yet to be commonplace.

BIOS

The BIOS on ASUS motherboards has been some of the most feature rich and stable ones that



we've come across. All the features

work as intended and with short descriptions, it's also easier to make heads or tails of the different configuration settings. The new BIOS also comes with some 'AI' features, most of which pertains to overclocking and cooling. Automatic overclocking on the basis of sensor data which monitors current, voltage, temperatures has been around for some generations now. And it is advisable to run a few benchmarks or heavy loads during the training phase so that the BIOS can figure out exactly how much it can push your processor without burdening the CPU cooler. You can always retrain whenever you swap out components later down the line.

PERFORMANCE

While our motherboard reviews are primarily feature-centric, we do run a few benchmarks to see if everything is running normal. With Cinebench the Ryzen 9 9950X scored 136 in Single-Threaded and 2284 in Multi-Threaded runs. Transcoding AV1 footage saw the 9950X hit the top of the chart beating the 14900K. In Procyon productivity benchmarks, the 9950X topped the chart again with nearly 9948 points in Word, 8770 in PowerPoint and 11277 in Excel. Overclocking the processor was also easy with a few simple settings in the BIOS to set the RAM to 6400 MT/s and ramping the voltage on the CPU to 1.30 V. We ran Cinebench for 30 minutes straight at a go to check for stability issues and it ran absolutely fine.

VERDICT

The ASUS ROG STRIX X870E-E GAMING WIFI is a top-tier motherboard built for gamers and enthusiasts who want to harness the full potential of AMD's Ryzen 9000 series processors, including the upcoming X3D variants. With PCIe 5.0 support, superior power delivery, and extensive connectivity options, this motherboard is ready for next-gen gaming and high-performance computing. While priced on the premium side, the ROG Strix X870E-E Gaming WiFi delivers excellent value with its forward-looking features, making it a solid investment for gamers building their next high-end rig.

—Mithun Mohandas

SPECIFICATIONS

Chipset: AMD X870E | Memory support: 4x 8400(OC)MT/s up to 192 GB | LAN: Realtek 5G Gigabit Ethernet | Audio: Realtek ALC 4080 | SATA: 4x SATA III | Expansion: 2x PCIe X16(x16+x4) | Dimensions (LxWxD): 305 mm x 244 mm | Warranty: 3 years.

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